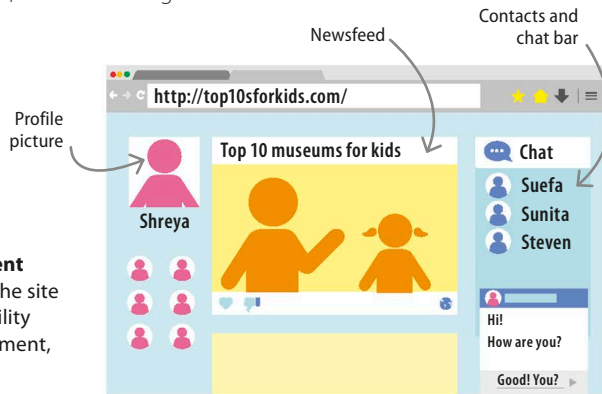


Profiles and newsfeeds

Whether using an app or a website, social media platforms have similar layouts. Users can upload a picture of themselves, called a profile picture, that makes them identifiable to others. When users log in, they have a newsfeed of what their connections have been uploading to the site since they last checked in, sometimes along with news on what has been trending (popular recently) on the site. There might be ads or sponsored posts there, too. Many platforms also offer users the opportunity to talk to each other in private, play games together, take part in competitions, and other things.



▷ Interacting with content

Each piece of content on the site usually offers users the ability to react in some way, comment, and share.

LINGO

Selfie

A self-portrait, usually taken with a digital camera or smartphone, is called a "selfie". Though self-portraits are nothing new, the rise of social media has led to an explosion in the number of people taking them. Selfies can be taken by hand, or by attaching a "selfie stick" to the smartphone, which allows the picture to be taken from further away.



◁ Media sharing

Users can usually comment on any piece of unrestricted content on social media, and can share it with their own connections, too. When something is shared by a lot of people in a short time, it is said to have "gone viral".

Communication ▷

The instant nature of social media makes it easier for friends and family to stay in touch, regardless of the physical distance between them.

